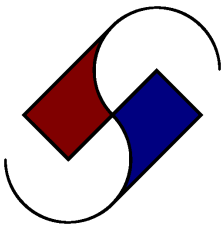
Integrated Postal Architecture
IPA Overview

Precision Postal Software Design

PSL's business strategy is to provide a totally Integrated Postal Architecture (IPA) that enables Postal Enterprises to implement cost-effective, flexible, integrated solutions in their key operational areas.



The Integrated Postal Architecture ensures that information can flow freely between the key areas of automation enabling the Postal Enterprise to gain maximum benefit from their investment in technology-based solutions.

The **Integrated Postal Architecture** offers a complete infrastructure for a Post with the following benefits:

- ⇒ Common Windows NT/2000 environment for all systems
- ⇒ Reduced technical and operations training due to common modular approach
- ⇒ Simplified and reduced support costs
- ⇒ Seamless environment for all functional operational areas
- ⇒ Information captured once only
- ⇒ Management gain a single clear view of the business of the Postal Enterprise
- ⇒ Flexibility of software to support changes in the business profile of the Postal Enterprise
- ⇒ Implementation of modules can be planned to be in line with the business strategy

Automation Roadmap

There are many potential operational areas that can be automated within a Post. Using the Integrated Postal Architecture, it is a relatively simple process for a Post to prepare an Automation Roadmap, in line with the business strategy.

Different Posts will have different automation priorities, but the Automation Roadmap clearly defines the direction the Post is heading with regard to automation, and importantly, will provide a reasonable view of the financial and human resources required to get there.

The development of an Automation Roadmap enables a Postal Enterprise to plan more effectively and grow the business of the Enterprise far more effectively.

Make the Most of your Data

The majority of the transaction information required by a Postal Enterprise is captured within the post office branches, mostly at the counters. Within the Integrated Postal Architecture, this information is captured by the *CORVUS* branch/counter automation system

The Integrated Postal Architecture enables specific types of transaction information to be routed to the relevant central systems for further processing.

For example, when a money order is issued at a counter, the transaction information will be processed within the post office for local reporting and will appear within the cash account. In addition the necessary information will also be passed to the *INDIGO3* central money order management system which will route the information to the redeeming post office, match the issues with the redemptions, and provide key business reports to the management.

Similarly, when an express mail item is received across the counter, the relevant information is routed to the *TRAZAR* central mail tracking system. This then sets up the initial Item information in the central *TRAZAR* tracking database and records the initial event "received item from customer"

Any stock sales made at the counter will effect the stockholding for the clerk, the office and the central inventory management system, enabling an Enterprise-wide inventory management system.

By managing the data collected in the post offices effectively, and routing the data to the key central systems, we can ensure that information is keyed into a computer once only and used to best effect by the Postal Enterprise. This information becomes a valuable asset to the Postal Enterprise and enables the management to view valuable information relating to the development of the business.

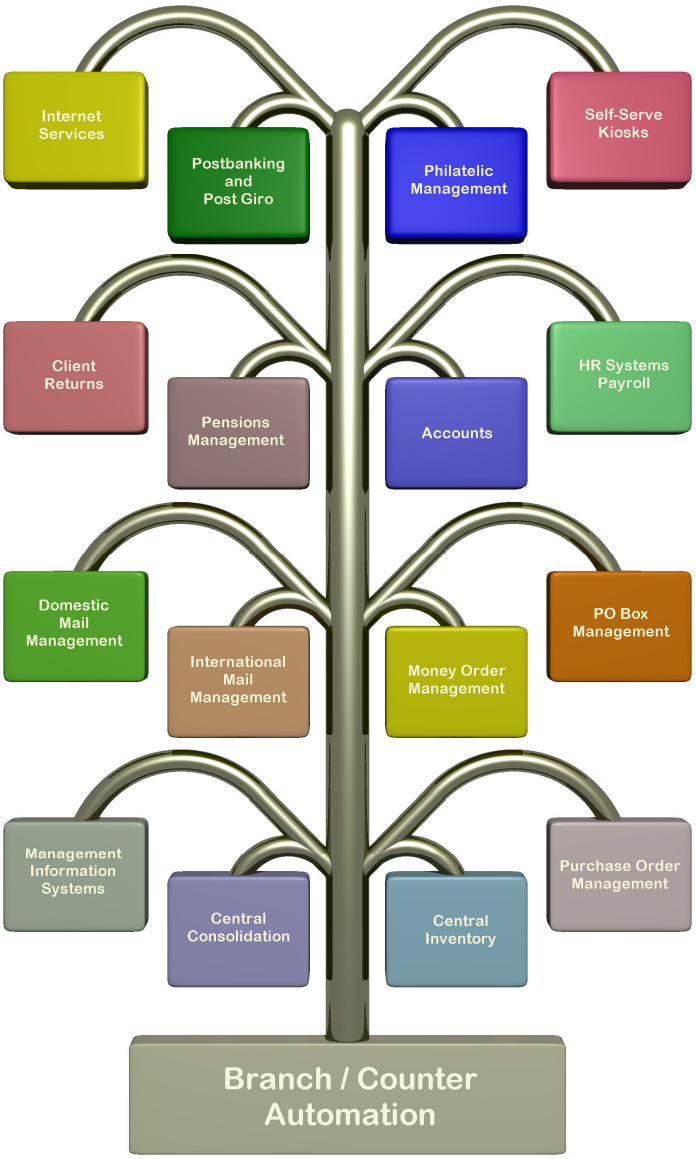
The majority of IPA modules are developed by PSL. Nevertheless, where widely-used systems exist, PSL integrates to existing software. An example of this is the inclusion of the UPU's International Postal System (IPS) as a the international tracking module of the Integrated Postal Architecture.

The integration capabilities of the IPA modules also enables efficient integration with other third-party modules such as Central Accounting Systems, Postbanking Systems and Client Systems in order to provide for electronic returns for Clients (for example for bill payment services).

IPA = Cost-effective, Flexible, Integrated Solutions for the Postal Industry

Many Posts have developed or purchased solutions to address specific areas of automation, only to find that the integration of their chosen solutions is much more complex than they imagined.

By using state-of-the-art software techniques and off-the-shelf software tools that adhere to industry standard interfacing methods, it is possible to build solutions with the degree of flexibility required to solve the business and technical problems encountered when automating Postal Enterprises.



The Integrated Postal Architecture (IPA) consists of a broad range of integrated operational solutions for the Postal Industry. The range of solutions currently forming the IPA include:

- ⇒ The Branch/Counter Automation module known as *CORVUS*
- ⇒ The Mail Tracking module known as *TRAZAR*
- ⇒ The Barcode Label Generator module
- ⇒ The Pensions Management module known as *OSMIUM*
- ⇒ The Money Order Management module known as *INDIGO3*
- ⇒ The PO Box Management module known as *PYXIS*
- ⇒ Philatelic Management module known as *PHILIPA*
- ⇒ Interface to the UPU's International Postal System (IPS)
- ⇒ Self-service and kiosk modules in association with Hoft and Wessel
- ⇒ Internet access capabilities for mail item and money order tracking and software distribution

Cost-effective - the power of PSL's unique development environment enables solutions to be tailored in a fraction of the time taken using traditional methods, thus minimising the costs.

Flexible - all modules of the IPA are developed to be easily tailored to meet the precise requirements of each Post. This flexibility of design enables IPA software modules to be easily modified to meet future changes in the requirements of the Post.

Integrated - all modules of the IPA are designed to integrate as an overall automated infrastructure for a Postal Enterprise.

In summary, PSL's Integrated Postal Architecture consists of a number of application modules, which can be implemented by a postal enterprise either individually, or as an integrated suite of applications - built on common principals and a compatible software platform. Further, by adhering to industry standards, interfacing to legacy systems or third-party system becomes relatively straightforward.

Postal Solutions Limited,
Lower Farm Barns,
Bainton Road,
Bucknell,
Bicester OX27 7LT, England
Tel: +44-1869-364000
Fax: +44-1869-364001
info@postalsolutions.co.uk

Cost-effective / Flexible / Integrated

Precision Postal Software Design